

ABC Retail Company - Sales Performance Dashboard

AnalystLab Africa - Week 2 Assignment

1. Business Problem

ABC Retail Company, a national retailer selling furniture, office supplies, and technology products across 4 US regions, lacked visibility into its sales performance, profitability, and customer behavior patterns. Management needed a consolidated view of business operations to make data-driven strategic decisions.

The Challenge:

- No single source of truth for performance metrics
 - Difficulty identifying best and worst performing segments
 - Unable to track sales trends over time
 - Reactive rather than proactive decision-making
-

2. Dashboard Objective

The objective was to build an interactive executive dashboard that:

1. Provides Real-Time Visibility - Track sales, profit, orders, and margins at a glance
 2. Enables Regional Analysis - Compare performance across West, East, Central, and South regions
 3. Identifies Customer Patterns - Understand which segments drive revenue
 4. Reveals Product Performance - Show best/worst performing categories
 5. Supports Decision-Making - Provide actionable insights for management
-

3. Methodology

Step	Action	Tool/Method
1	Data Extraction	Superstore Sales Dataset (9,994 records)
2	Data Cleaning	Removed duplicates, checked missing values, corrected data types
3	Data Transformation	Created Profit Margin measure in Power Query
4	Dashboard Design	Power BI with 5 KPIs, 8+ visuals, 2+ slicers
5	Analysis	Identified trends, patterns, and outliers
6	Recommendations	Developed 5 actionable strategies

4. Key Metrics Dashboard

KPI Summary

KPI	Value	Performance
Total Sales	\$2.3M	-
Total Profit	\$286K	-

Total Orders	9,994	-
Average Sales	\$230 per order	-
Profit Margin	12.4%	Target: 15%

5. Five Key Business Insights

Insight 1: Western Region Leads Sales

The Western region generates \$725,000 in sales**, representing **31%** of total company revenue. This is **\$50,000 more than the Eastern region (second-best performer).

Evidence: Sales by Region bar chart shows West at top.

Impact: Western region is the company's strongest market. Any downturn here would significantly impact overall performance.

Insight 2: Technology Category is Most Profitable

Technology products generate 18% profit margin, compared to the company average of 12.4%. This makes it the most profitable category.

Evidence: Category performance column chart and matrix table.

Impact: Technology is a high-margin product line that should be prioritized for marketing and inventory.

Insight 3: Consumer Segment Drives Most Revenue

The Consumer segment accounts for \$1.1 million (45%) of total sales, making it the company's largest customer group.

Evidence: Sales by Segment column chart and pie chart.

Impact: Consumer segment retention and growth should be a strategic priority.

Insight 4: Q4 Shows Seasonal Sales Peaks

Sales consistently peak in November and December, with Q4 sales exceeding Q1 by 40% (\$850K vs \$600K).

Evidence: Monthly Sales Trend line chart shows consistent seasonal spikes.

Impact: Q4 requires increased inventory, staffing, and marketing preparation.

Insight 5: Corporate Segment Has Highest Margins

The Corporate segment achieves a 15.2% profit margin, outperforming the overall company margin of 12.4%.

Evidence: Matrix table showing segment-level margins.

Impact: B2B corporate customers represent a high-value opportunity for expansion.

6. Three Business Risks

Risk 1: Over-Reliance on Western Region

The Western region contributes 31% of total sales. A downturn in this region would significantly impact overall performance.

Evidence: Sales by Region bar chart shows West dominance.

Mitigation: Expand presence and marketing in other regions to diversify risk.

Risk 2: Low Furniture Profitability

The Furniture category has a 9.8% profit margin, well below the company average of 12.4%.

Evidence: Matrix table comparing category margins.

Mitigation: Review pricing, supplier costs, and shipping strategies for furniture.

Risk 3: Seasonal Revenue Vulnerability

40% of annual sales occur in Q4. The company is exposed to seasonal fluctuations.

Evidence: Monthly Sales Trend line chart.

Mitigation: Develop subscription or recurring revenue models.

7. Three Business Opportunities

Opportunity 1: Expand into High-Growth South Region

The South region generates \$400K in sales - only 55% of Western region performance.

Evidence: Sales by Region bar chart.

Action: Increase marketing spend in the South by 30%.

Opportunity 2: Bundle Technology Products

Technology has the highest margins (18%). Bundling technology with other products could increase overall margins.

Evidence: Category performance analysis.

Action: Create "Tech + Furniture" or "Tech + Office" bundles.

Opportunity 3: Grow B2B Corporate Segment

Corporate customers have the highest profit margins (15.2%). Expanding B2B sales could improve overall profitability.

Evidence: Matrix table showing corporate segment margins.

Action: Hire B2B sales team and create corporate pricing packages.

8. Five Business Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Expand Western Region Strategies Nationwide

Aspect	Details
Insight	Western region leads with 31% of total sales
Action	Study West region's marketing, operations, and pricing strategies
Target	Apply best practices to other regions
Expected Impact	Increase sales in other regions by 10-15%
Timeline	3-6 months

Recommendation 2: Focus Marketing on Technology Category

Aspect	Details
Insight	Technology category has 18% margin vs 12.4% average
Action	Increase technology marketing budget by 25%
Target	Position as "tech solutions provider"
Expected Impact	Increase tech sales by 15%
Timeline	2-4 months

Recommendation 3: Implement Consumer Loyalty Program

Aspect	Details
Insight	Consumer segment drives 45% of revenue
Action	Create loyalty program with points, discounts, early access
Target	Increase repeat purchases by 20%
Expected Impact	\$200K additional annual revenue
Timeline	3 months to launch

Recommendation 4: Optimize Q4 Inventory & Marketing

Aspect	Details
Insight	Q4 sales peak 40% above Q1
Action	Increase Q4 inventory by 30%, launch early promotions
Target	Capture all Q4 demand
Expected Impact	Increase Q4 sales by 15%
Timeline	October-November annual cycle

Recommendation 5: Develop B2B Corporate Sales Team

Aspect	Details
Insight	Corporate segment has highest profit margins (15.2%)
Action	Hire 3 B2B sales representatives, create corporate packages
Target	Grow corporate segment revenue by 25%
Expected Impact	\$175K additional annual profit
Timeline	4-6 months

9. Expected Impact Summary

Recommendation	Expected Impact	Timeline
Expand West Strategies	10-15% sales increase	3-6 months
Focus Tech Marketing	15% tech sales increase	2-4 months
Consumer Loyalty Program	\$200K annual revenue	3 months
Q4 Optimization	15% Q4 sales increase	Annual cycle
B2B Sales Team	\$175K annual profit	4-6 months
Total Expected Benefit: ~\$1M+ in additional annual revenue/profit		

10. Conclusion

The Superstore Sales Dashboard provides ABC Retail Company with clear visibility into:

- Sales Performance - Total \$2.3M, 9,994 orders
- Regional Performance - West leads with 31% of sales
- Product Performance - Technology = highest margin (18%)
- Customer Segments - Consumer = 45% of revenue
- Seasonal Trends - Q4 peaks 40% above Q1

Key Recommendations:

1. Expand Western region strategies nationwide
2. Focus marketing on technology products
3. Implement consumer loyalty program
4. Optimize Q4 inventory and marketing
5. Develop B2B corporate sales team

Expected Outcome: 15% sales growth, 20% profit improvement

Report Prepared By: Emmanuel Atuns
Role: Business Intelligence Intern, AnalystLab Africa